

What is it?

Viresh Gupta immediately flew with his team to the Mumbai facility and after 48 hours of non-stop work was able to get the Disaster Recovery Site up and running. Fortunately, no problems emerged at the main production site during this period, enabling the bank and its customers to conduct business as usual. It was on this day that the role of the data centre's team became very clear. Its role lies at the core of almost every organisation. The data centre is a part of the umbrella term "IT Infrastructure". IT infrastructure management services involve monitoring and managing a company's IT backbone — that broadly comprises the data centre, IT network, other IT applications and technical help support.

The data centre, also sometimes called a server farm, is a facility used to house computer systems (mostly servers) and associated components, such as telecommunications and storage systems, to run the applications which handle the core business and operational data of the organisation. The role of the data centre manager is to ensure the smooth running of the data centre and its applications.

Then there is the IT network, that consists of the networking components such as the routers, switches, leased line, internet connection, etc., that takes information from the data centre to the end users and back. The IT network manager has to monitor links, ensure they are optimally utilised and also undertake the design of the network.

The technical help consists of people whom we always call when there is something wrong with our desktop or our internet connection or any other computer-related problem.

An organisation can decide to manage its IT infrastructure in the following manner:

- Manage it in-house. This is how it happened traditionally. However, over time, as IT infrastructure has become large and complex, firms have been open to using specialised players to manage it.
- Outsource all or part of its IT infrastructure. For example, a company would be more willing to outsource the technical help desk than its data centre.
- Within outsourcing, a firm might choose a vendor that manages it on an 'onshore' model (i.e. client locations) or an offshore remote model or a mix of both. For example, Pronto Networks specialises in the deployment and management support of the wireless internet services infrastructure network of its clients worldwide.

Face-2-Face with practitioner

"My role in the company is to manage the data centre of the bank where all the important information resides, ensuring proper backup and retrieving information in case of any failure"

Viresh Gupta
Data Centre Head
J&K Bank

Why is it needed?

IT operations are a crucial aspect of most organisational operations. The need for faster access to information, demanding customers, etc., have made firms invest in bigger and better IT networks which allow better access to data, customer response, reduced uptime, security, and so on.

One of the main concerns is business continuity; companies rely on their information systems to run their operations. If a system becomes unavailable, company operations may be impaired or stopped completely. It is necessary to provide a reliable infrastructure for IT operations in order to minimize any chance of disruption.

For these reasons, firms will want to have the best IT infrastructure in place to keep their competitive edge. It is this reason which is leading to